

House Aedria

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"HONOR TO THE LESSER"

Quick Facts

Status: Count/Countess

Origin: Aicruae (Eastern), ties to House Liazen

Founded: 8,516 BR (shortly after Kaernio and Cairya's wedding)

Official Founder: Kaernio Aedria

"Real" Founder: Atiane Aedria (created the house motto, designed the crest, lifelong charity work)

Name Meaning: Servant of the Gods

Seat: Haleker, Eastern Aicruae (opposite side of town from House Vika)

Faction: Neutral (despite ties to the Divine Faction, thanks to Atiane)

Spirit Animal: Ram (a knight riding a ram with sword and shield)

Colors:

Wealth: ~138,000 Rern (from The Aedria, Kanus Company / TAKC)

Military: Merchant family that also operates as a knight family; one of the noble houses that produce the most knights for the crown

Religion: Barqeten

Theme Song: "Breath of Life" by Florence + The Machine

Status By Era

Pre-Empire Era: Count/Countess. Founded in 8,516 BR as a wedding gift from the king. One of the most publicly loved houses in Aicruae, built on charity, commerce, and knightly service to the crown.

Solis's Era: Count/Countess. Head of house: Janileandora Aedria. House Aedria survives the civil war between Solis and the twins, with the family's line continuing through Lady Alizieya Aedria.

Crandona's Era: [TBD]

Minara's Era: [TBD]

Why They Matter

House Aedria was born from something ugly. A 32-year-old man married a 17-year-old exile who'd already been abused by her own family, and the king signed off because the groom was his friend. Cairya Liazan endured countless miscarriages, a husband who cheated on her with even younger girls, and died at 27 giving birth to her second child. Kaernio was so despised by his own children that they called him "the enemy" and refused him a proper burial.

But from that rotten foundation, the Aedria children built something extraordinary. Zolair became one of the most powerful magic users in Aicruae's history, earning the title "nation's treasure" and changing the country's position in global trade. Elsenthe restructured the house into a dual matriarchal-patriarchal power system and reformed divorce laws to protect women. Atiane gave the house its conscience, its motto, and its crest. Kanus turned the Aedria name into a household staple through commerce. They co-founded the Council of the Forsaken, a feared alliance that cut the kingdom's crime rate to 30%.

House Aedria is the proof that a family's legacy doesn't have to be defined by the man who started it. Everything good about this house came after Kaernio, and most of it came from the women.

Heraldry

The Crest: Azure, a knight in full silver armor mounted upon a white ram passant with brown horns, the knight bearing a sword raised in dexter and a blue shield in sinister, plumed azure. The shield is bordered brown. Below, a tilted silver helm with blue and white oak leaf mantling.

Symbolism: The knight riding a ram is the soul of House Aedria, service and humility fused into a single image. A knight is the highest expression of duty to the crown, and House Aedria produces more knights for the king than nearly any other noble family. But Atiane Aedria, the woman who designed this crest, didn't put the knight on a warhorse. She put him on a ram. The ram is a creature of the common pasture, of shepherds and farmland, of the people the Aedrias swore to protect. The message is deliberate: House Aedria rides to battle on the back of the lesser, and they will never forget who carries them.

The raised sword represents the house's willingness to fight, not for territory or ambition, but for justice. House Aedria is a founding member of the Council of the Forsaken, and their knights serve the crown directly. The sword is lifted, not sheathed. The Aedrias are not passive.

The blue shield carried in the knight's off-hand represents loyalty and sovereignty, loyalty to the crown, to the common people, and to the faith. Blue is the dominant color of the house because loyalty is the dominant virtue. Everything House Aedria built after Kaernio, the charity, the commerce, the knighthood, the Council was built on earning the trust their founder never deserved.

The brown border represents modesty. House Aedria is a count's family, not dukes, not royalty. They sit in Eastern Aicruae across the town from House Vika, and they have never tried to be anything grander than what they are. Brown is the earth. Brown is the ground. The Aedrias stay close to it.

The tilted helm with oak leaf mantling beneath the shield is a mark of knightly rank and tournament tradition a declaration that House Aedria earns its standing through service, not inheritance. The oak leaves represent endurance and strength. This is a family that survived its own poisoned origins and grew into something the entire kingdom wants to be.

House Colors: Blue and Brown. Blue for loyalty, sovereignty, and devotion to the crown and the faith. Brown for modesty, humility, and closeness to the common people.

Motto: "Honor to the Lesser." Created by Atiane Aedria, the woman considered the true founder of the house. The motto is a command and a confession. It tells every Aedria who comes after her that their purpose is not to climb higher but to reach lower to the orphans Atiane built homes for, to the impoverished children she created jobs for, to the women Elsenthe wrote divorce protections for, to every person in Aicruae who has no title and no name and no one fighting for them. The "lesser" are not lesser at all. That's the point. The motto is a rebuke of everything Kaernio represented a man who married a powerless girl because he could and a promise that House Aedria will never again be defined by someone who sees people beneath him as things to use.

Power & Influence

Source of Power

Commerce (The Aedria, Kanus Company), knightly service to the crown, charity, and public goodwill. House Aedria's influence comes less from military might and more from being genuinely beloved by the common people and respected by other houses.

Internal Power Structure

Both matriarchal and patriarchal, a dual system established by Elsenthe Aedria. Leadership isn't restricted by gender.

Military Forces

House Aedria is a merchant family that also operates as a knight family. They are one of the noble houses that produce the most knights for the king and the crown. They don't command a private army the way House Vika does, but their contribution to the crown's military through knighthood is significant.

Lands & Income

Seat: The town of Haleker in Eastern Aicruae, on the opposite side of town from House Vika.

Wealth: ~138,000 Rern, earned through The Aedria, Kanus Company (TAKC).

Key industries: Fragrance and soap (TAKC's perfume brand), trade, and commerce.

Lands controlled: [TBD]

Alliances & Rivalries

Allied Houses

House Liazen (Birth Family of Cairya). Cairya was born into House Liazen before her marriage to Kaernio. The Liazen branch she came from had a connection to Vikistv blood heritage, which is how magic manifested in the Aedria line. Queen Isilian Liazen, a distant relative of Kanus Aedria, introduced the concept of perfume to Aicruae, and her idea inspired the creation of TAKC.

House Arvento (Marriage Alliance & Council of the Forsaken). Two marriage alliances connect the families: Rorca Arvento married Bariaro Aedria, and Laitha Arvento I married Jeart Aedria. Both families are members of the Council of the Forsaken and belong to the neutral political faction.

House Najil (Marriage Alliance). Lady Erhen Aedria married Matasen Najil and had nine children together, including Basiol Najil.

House Patton / Royal Family (Adoption & King's Affection). Zolair Aedria was adopted as a Des (distant relative) of the royal family and received the King's Affection.

House Caraen (Council of the Forsaken). Both families are founding members of the Council of the Forsaken.

Rival Houses

[TBD]

Shared Territory

House Vika. Both houses share the town of Haleker, occupying opposite ends of the city. Both are known for inflicting "brutish punishments" on criminals

House Culture

Religion

Barqeten. Followers of Barqeten believe that by simply existing, they worship the gods. The faith emphasizes physical and mental wellness.

Traditions

[TBD]

Values

The common people. House Aedria's identity is rooted in service to those beneath them, not above.

Reputation

The “IT family” of Aicruae. Everyone wants to be them. They are loved and respected by other noble houses, a reputation built primarily through the legacies of Elsenthe, Kanus, and Zolair, and cemented by Atiane’s lifelong charity work.

How Others Perceive Them

[TBD]

History

Founding (8,516 BR)

House Aedria was created as a wedding gift. The king, a close friend of Kaernio’s, granted him land and a noble title when he married Cairya Liazen. The name “Aedria” means “Servant of the Gods.” In the public eye, the house and the marriage were presented as happy. Behind closed doors, the reality was far uglier. Kaernio married a 17-year-old exile at age 32 in what was effectively a coerced union. The king at the time saw nothing wrong with it and allowed it because of his friendship with Kaernio. The match set a precedent for what was considered acceptable in Aicruaen society and spread considerable controversy, even as the public image remained polished.

Rise to Power

House Aedria’s rise had nothing to do with its founder. Zolair Aedria’s extraordinary magical talent, approaching or surpassing saint-level abilities, brought international attention to Aicruae and changed the country’s trading position globally. He earned the King’s Affection and was adopted as a Des of the royal family. His sister Elsenthe created magical instruments, reformed the house’s power structure, and lowered the land tax. Atiane, considered by many to be the “real founder,” created the house’s motto, designed the crest, and spent her life building orphanages and businesses that created jobs for impoverished children. Kanus turned a distant relative’s idea into a commercial empire with TAKC, earning the house 25,000 Rern and making the Aedria name a household staple.

Major Achievements

The Aedria, Kanus Company (TAKC), a fragrance and soap company that became a commercial empire. Magical instruments created by Elsenthe Aedria.

Participation in the Battle of Jatlya (Zolair served while Elsenthe administered the territory). The King's Affection, awarded to Zolair. Zolair's adoption as official Des of the royal family. The Council of the Forsaken (founding member alongside House Arvento and House Caraen; reduced the kingdom's crime rate to 30%; formed 8,051 BR).

Major Disgraces

[TBD] (Though the house's founding circumstances, Kaernio's marriage to a 17-year-old exile at 32, the spread of controversies surrounding the union, and his children's refusal to give him a proper burial are all part of the record.)

The Battle of Jatlya & the Kalip Plague (8,160s BR)

In the closing years of the War of World's End, a devastating plague the Kalip Plague swept through the war-torn lands. Men across Aicruae were scouted for battle, and Zolair Aedria was among those called to serve. He left his sister Elsenthe in charge of House Aedria's territory while he fought at Jatlya. What he came home to was a house better run than when he'd left it. The people loved Elsenthe's leadership, and Zolair handed the family headship to her on his return. The Battle of Jatlya is one of House Aedria's major achievements not because of what Zolair did on the battlefield, but because of what Elsenthe built while he was gone.

Notable Members

Listed chronologically, from the house's origins through its later generations.

Kaernio Aedria (8,548 BR – 8,499 BR)

Official Founder of House Aedria

Name meaning: Tired

The king's friend who received land and a noble title as a wedding gift when he married Cairya Liazan. Kaernio was 32 when he married the 17-year-old exile. He is the official founder of House Aedria, but a controversial figure. While the house and the marriage appeared happy in the public eye, the reality was different. The king at the time saw nothing wrong with the union and allowed it because of his friendship with Kaernio, setting a precedent for what was acceptable in Aicruaen

society. His children called him "the enemy" and refused to give him a proper burial. He died at 49.

Cairyia Aedria (8,533 BR – 8,506 BR)

Born Cairyia Liazen | "The Great Tragedy of the Warrior's Age"

Name meaning: Lady of the Sun

Born into House Liazen, Cairyia was exiled at 17 for "unladylike behavior," which included stealing and loss of virginity. The truth behind those charges was uglier: she had been abused by her uncle at 15, and House Liazen responded by imprisoning and starving her rather than punishing the uncle. After her exile, she began manifesting magic thought to have been lost in the Liazen family, proof of the family's Vikistv blood heritage.

She was coerced into marriage with Kaernio at 17. Over the course of their marriage, she suffered countless miscarriages, and her husband cheated on her multiple times with even younger girls. She died at 27 giving birth to her second child, Elsenthe. Her eldest was Zolair. Cairyia is remembered as "the great tragedy of the so-called warrior's age or golden age."

Lady Erhen Aedria

Dates not specified

Married Matasen Najil (8,534 BR – 8,465 BR) and had nine children together. Their son Basiol Najil (8,498 BR – 8,439 BR) is among the most notable of those children.

Zolair Aedria (8,515 BR – 8,440 BR)

"Nation's Treasure" | "Nation's Gift" | "Nation's Sunshine"

Name meaning: Sunlight

Eldest child of Cairyia and Kaernio. Zolair possessed extraordinary magical talent approaching or surpassing saint-level abilities, making him one of the earliest and youngest examples of a magic user surpassing saint abilities. His power brought international attention to Aicruae and changed the country's trading position globally.

He received the King's Affection and was adopted as a Des (distant relative) of the royal family. Unlike his father, Zolair respected women and allowed his sister Elsenthe's abilities to flourish. When he was scouted to join the Battle of Jatlya, he left Elsenthe in charge of House Aedria's territory. Upon his return, he saw the quality of her leadership and handed the position of head of the family over to her. He died at 75.

Elsenthe Aedria (8,506 BR – 8,442 BR)

Name meaning: Sunkissed

Only daughter and younger child of Cairya and Kaernio. Some speculate she was even more magically powerful than Zolair. Elsenthe created magical instruments using her abilities.

When her brother was called to serve in the Battle of Jatlya, she was left in charge of House Aedria's territory. The people loved her. Once Zolair returned, he gave her the position of head of the family because he saw how great a job she had done, and because, unlike their father, he respected her as an equal and saw the value of women.

As head of the house, Elsenthe lowered House Aedria's land tax, created better rules for divorce to help women in the territory (building on rules already established), and established the dual matriarchal-patriarchal power structure that defines House Aedria to this day. She died at 64.

Atiane Aedria (8,290 BR – 8,181 BR)

"The Real Founder"

Name meaning: Noble Blade

Considered by many to be the true founder of House Aedria. Atiane created the house saying "Honor to the Lesser," designed the family's crest, and devoted her life to charity work. She established orphanages and businesses that created jobs for poor and impoverished children.

Atiane is the reason House Aedria is loved and respected despite its controversial origins. She is also the reason the house sits in the neutral political faction, despite its ties to the divine faction through the Liazen family. She died at 109.

Jeart Aedria

Dates not specified

Married Laitha Arvento I (7,651 BR – 7,582 BR). Laitha was so taken with him that she based all the male leads in her romance novels after him. She received the title of Golden Pen for her books.

Kanus Aedria (7,532 BR – 7,415 BR)

Merchant and Heir to House Aedria

Name meaning: Little Prince

The merchant who turned the Aedria name into a brand. Kanus created a fragrance and soap company based on an idea from his distant relative Queen Isilian Liazen, who had introduced the concept of perfume to Aicruae. He founded The Aedria, Kanus Company (TAKC) and created a perfume brand within it.

TAKC earned House Aedria 25,000 Rern and made the family name a household staple across the kingdom. He died at 117.

Bariaro Aedria

Dates not specified

Married Rorca Arvento, who proposed to him. They lived happily together. Rorca died at 68, Bariaro at 71. Without Rorca, Bariaro spent his last days in agony.

The Council of the Forsaken

Formed in 8,051 BR, forty-three years after the Taguar Murders (8,094 BR). The Council of the Forsaken was an alliance of three neutral noble families: House Arvento, House Aedria, and House Caraen. It functioned as a medieval police department investigating violent crimes. The Council had the king's approval and was greatly feared. Under its authority, the kingdom's crime rate was reduced to 30%.

Strengths & Weaknesses

Known For

Public goodwill, commercial success (TAKC), knightly service to the crown, charity work, magical talent (Zolair and Elsenthe), founding role in the Council of the Forsaken, and a reputation as the house everyone wants to be associated with.

What They Lack

[TBD]

Vulnerabilities

[TBD]

Role in Narrative

Book Appearances: Book 1 (A Tale of a Thousand Songs).

Plot Significance: House Aedria survives the civil war between Solis and the twins. The family's line continues through Lady Alizieya Aedria. Head of house during Solis's Era is Janileandora Aedria.

Key Members in Story: Janileandora Aedria, Alizieya Aedria, Exara Aedria, Olia Aedria. All appear in A Tale of a Thousand Songs.

Cross-References

House Liazen, House Arvento, House Najil, House Patton, House Caraen, House Vika, House Leva, Queen Isilian Liazen, Cairya Liazen/Aedria, Kaernio Aedria, Zolair Aedria, Elsenthe Aedria, Atiane Aedria, Kanus Aedria, Bariaro Aedria, Rorca Arvento, Jeart Aedria, Laitha Arvento I, Lady Erhen Aedria, Matasen Najil, Basiol Najil, Janileandora Aedria, Alizieya Aedria, Exara Aedria, Olia Aedria, Eastern Aicruae, Town of Haleker, The Aedria Kanus Company (TAKC), Council of the Forsaken, Taguar Murders, Battle of Jatlya, Kalip Plague, War of World's End, King's Affection, Des (Distant Relative of the Royal Family), Barqeten (Religion), Rillic (mentioned in House Liazen context), Vikistv Blood Heritage, Magical Instruments, Rern (Currency), Divine Faction, Neutral Faction, A Tale of a Thousand Songs (Book 1)

Keywords

House Aedria, Aedria, Servant of the Gods, Count, Countess, Eastern Aicruae, Haleker, Honor to the Lesser, Neutral Faction, Ram, Knight on a Ram, Blue, Purple, Brown, Barqeten, Breath of Life, Florence and the Machine, TAKC, The Aedria Kanus Company, Rern, Kaernio Aedria, Tired, Cairya Aedria, Cairya Liazen, Lady of the Sun, House Liazen, Vikistv Blood Heritage, Zolair Aedria, Sunlight, Nation's Treasure, Nation's Gift, Nation's Sunshine, King's Affection, Des, Saint-Level Magic, Elsenthe Aedria, Sunkissed, Magical Instruments, Dual Power Structure, Matriarchal, Patriarchal, Battle of Jatlya, Kalip Plague, War of World's End, Atiane Aedria, Noble Blade, Real Founder, Orphanages, Charity, Kanus Aedria, Little Prince, Perfume, Queen Isilian Liazen, Bariaro Aedria, Rorca Arvento, Jeart Aedria, Laitha Arvento I, Golden Pen, Lady Erhen Aedria, Matasen Najil, Basiol Najil, Council of the Forsaken, Taguar Murders, House Arvento, House Caraen, House Najil, House Patton, House Vika, Brutish Punishments, Janileandora Aedria, Alizieya Aedria, Exara Aedria, Olia Aedria, A Tale of a Thousand Songs, Civil War, Solis's Era